

WEEKLY CA – 16th May – 22nd May

1. The exhibition “My Own Collection” primarily showcases:

प्रदर्शनी “My Own Collection” मुख्य रूप से प्रदर्शित करती है:

- (a) Modern art installations only
- (b) Space technology exhibits
- (c) Rare historical objects and unique personal collections
- (d) Marine biodiversity specimens only

Answer: (c)

18 May International Museum Day

- The day was **officially created in 1977**, when a resolution approved by the **ICOM General Assembly in Moscow** was adopted.
- Goa Science Centre, Panaji, in collaboration with the Directorate of Museums, Government of Goa, will celebrate International Museum Day 2026 from May 16 to 18, 2026
- The **theme - “Museums Uniting a Divided World”**
- One lecture on “History & Heritage of Goa from Ancient Times to 2019” will also be held on May 16, 2026
- **ICOM, the International Council of Museums**, is a global organization for museums and museum professionals. It was **created in 1946** and is dedicated to **promoting and protecting cultural and natural heritage**.
- A special attraction of this year’s celebration is the exhibition “My Own Collection”, showcasing rare and fascinating historical objects along with unique personal collections reflecting the richness of India’s cultural and scientific heritage.



Date	Day	Theme
16 th May	International Day of Light	Light for a Sustainable Future
16 th May	National Dengue Day	
17 th May	World Telecommunication and Information Society Day	Digital lifelines: Strengthening resilience in a connected world "
17 th May	World Hypertension Day	Controlling Hypertension Together: check your blood pressure regularly, defeat the silent killer
18 th May	World AIDS Vaccine Day (HIV Vaccine Awareness Day)	
19 th May	World Fair Play Day	Embrace the Spirit of Fair Play
20 th May	World Bee Day	Bee Together for People and the Planet – A partnership that sustains us all
20 th May	World Metrology Day 2026	Metrology: Building Trust in Policy Making"
21 st May	International Tea Day	Sustaining Tea, Supporting Communities
21 st May	National Anti-Terrorism Day	
21 st May	World Day for Cultural Diversity for Dialogue and Development	
22 nd May	International Day for Biological Diversity	Acting locally for global impact

2. Project Saksham is an initiative launched by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) in partnership with:

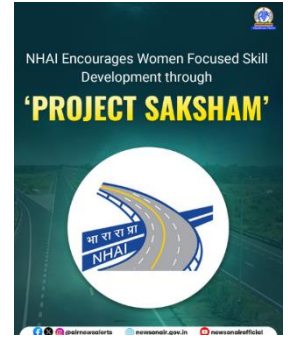
प्रोजेक्ट 'सक्षम' भारतीय राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग प्राधिकरण (NHAI) द्वारा निम्नलिखित के साथ साझेदारी में शुरू की गई एक पहल है:

- (a) Tata Trusts
- (b) Vertis Foundation
- (c) NASSCOM Foundation
- (d) SEWA Foundation

Answer: (b)

NHAI Encourages Women Focused Skill Development through 'Project Saksham'

- **National Highway Authority of India (NHAI) in partnership with the Vertis Foundation is empowering** rural women through structured skill development for sustainable livelihood opportunities through Project Saksham.
- Project Saksham operates through a network of 12 training centres across the country, providing access to underserved communities to industry-relevant skills and pathways into the formal workforce.
- Project Saksham is anchored in the belief that communities residing along the National Highways, in particular rural women, should directly benefit from the economic opportunities generated by infrastructure expansion.



3. The book Apnapan is based on:

'अपनापन' पुस्तक किस पर आधारित है?

- (a) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- (b) Lal Krishna Advani
- (c) Narendra Modi
- (d) Rajnath Singh

Answer: (c)

Union Minister Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan Pens 'Apnapan' Based on 35 Years of Experiences with Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi

- Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan has authored a book on Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- **Titled Apnapan, the book will be released on May 26 by former vice-president M Venkaiah Naidu and former prime minister H D Deve Gowda,**
- Chouhan, has served as the Madhya Pradesh chief minister



4. Multilateral Exercise PRAGATI 2026 is being conducted in which state?

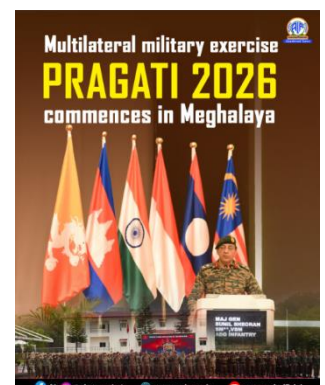
बहुपक्षीय अभ्यास 'प्रगति 2026' किस राज्य में आयोजित किया जा रहा है?

- A. Assam
- B. Meghalaya
- C. Nagaland
- D. Tripura

Answer: B

MULTILATERAL EXERCISE PRAGATI 2026 COMMENCES AT UMROI, MEGHALAYA

- The multilateral military exercise 'PRAGATI 2026' (Partnership of Regional Armies for Growth and Transformation in the Indian Ocean Region) commenced at Umroi Military Station **with the participation of 12 friendly nations — Bhutan, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Maldives, Myanmar, Nepal, Philippines, Seychelles, Sri Lanka and Vietnam.**
- **The objectives of the exercise** include enabling seamless coordination among participating nations in joint operations, identifying common areas of cooperation, sharing expertise and establishing an institutionalised mechanism for exchange of best practices evolved through individual experiences.



5. Taiwan Travelogue, winner of the 2026 International Booker Prize, was written by:

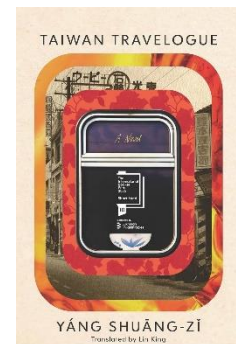
2026 के अंतर्राष्ट्रीय बुकर पुरस्कार की विजेता पुस्तक 'ताइवान ट्रेवलॉग' किसके द्वारा लिखी गई थी?

- A. Lin King
- B. Geetanjali Shree
- C. Yáng Shuāng-zǐ
- D. Banu Mushtaq

Answer: C.

'Taiwan Travelogue' wins International Booker Prize 2026

- Taiwan Travelogue by Yáng Shuāng-zǐ, translated by Lin King won the **2026 International Booker Prize**.
- Taiwanese writer Yáng Shuāng-zǐ's Taiwan Travelogue, translated from the Mandarin Chinese by Lin King.
- **The novel is Yáng Shuāng-zǐ's first to be translated into English** and the first translation from the Mandarin Chinese to win the International Booker Prize.
- This is also the second year in a row that the independent press, And Other Stories, has taken home the prize, following Heart Lamp last year.



About International Booker Prize

- It is awarded annually.
- It was **established in 2005 as the Man Booker International Prize**.
- It celebrates the best works of long-form fiction or collections of short stories translated into English and published in the UK and/or Ireland.
- It recognises the vital work of translators, with the £50,000 prize money divided equally between authors and translators.
- In **addition, shortlisted authors and translators each receive £2,500**.
- This prize aims to encourage more reading of quality fiction from all over the world.

Indian Winners of International Booker Prize

- **Geetanjali Shree** – Tomb of Sand (2022), translated by Daisy Rockwell. It was the first Hindi work to win this prize.
- **Banu Mushtaq** – Heart Lamp (2025), translated by Deepa Bhashti which was the first Kannada work to win this prize.

6. The AI-based helpbot "Abhay" was launched by the:

AI-आधारित हेल्पबॉट "अभय" किसके द्वारा लॉन्च किया गया था?

- (a) National Investigation Agency
- (b) Central Bureau of Investigation
- (c) Intelligence Bureau
- (d) National Crime Records Bureau

Answer: (b)

Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) launched an AI-based helpbot called "Abhay"

- The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) recently launched an **AI-based helpbot called "Abhay" for authentication of CBI notices**.
- **ABHAY (AI-Based Helpbot for Authentication of Your Notice)** is an AI-powered notice verification system launched by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI).
- **Purpose:** It is designed to help citizens identify fake CBI notices and protect themselves from rising "digital arrest" scams.
- **It is India's first real-time notice verification system developed specifically to combat cyber-enabled fraud and impersonation scams.**

How does the System Work?

- Users receiving notices in the name of the CBI can upload scanned copies of the documents on the platform after completing OTP verification.
- The **AI-based system then checks the authenticity of the notice and flags it as either genuine or potentially fraudulent.**
- The ABHAY system is available round-the-clock through the official CBI website and the dedicated verification portal, the ABHAY Verification Platform

7. P. Kumaran has been appointed as India's High Commissioner-designate to:

पी. कुमारन को भारत का नामित उच्चायुक्त नियुक्त किया गया है:

- Canada
- Australia
- Singapore
- United Kingdom

Answer: (d)

P. Kumaran takes charge as India's High Commissioner in London

- P. Kumaran assumed charge as India's High Commissioner-designate to the United Kingdom .
- Kumaran served as **India's Ambassador to Qatar from 2016 to 2020 and as High Commissioner to Singapore from 2020 to 2023.**
- The High Commissioner is the head of a diplomatic mission between Commonwealth countries, while an Ambassador heads a mission between non-Commonwealth states.
- **Recently , Vikram Doraiswami has taken over as India's Ambassador to China. (march 2026)**



8 'Kaal Bhairava' is described as India's first:

'काल भैरव' को भारत के पहले के रूप में वर्णित किया गया है:

- Hypersonic missile
- AI-powered combat aircraft
- Nuclear-powered submarine
- Stealth helicopter

Answer: (b)

Kaal Bhairava AI Combat Aircraft to Be Made in Portugal

- **Flying Wedge Defence & Aerospace (FWDA), an Indian AI warfare company, announced the establishment of its first international manufacturing node in Portugal for its flagship autonomous combat aircraft, Kaal Bhairava.**
- India's first AI-powered combat aircraft, Kaal Bhairava will be manufactured in **Portugal through a partnership with SKETCHPIXEL LDA**, a European technology firm known **for developing advanced fighter jet simulation systems for aircraft including the F-16.**
- The Portugal facility will serve as the first international node under Operation 777, a long-term strategic initiative conceptualised by, Founder and CEO of FWDA.
- **First unveiled during the launch of the Kaal Bhairava platform in 2025**, the initiative aims to establish manufacturing, integration, and deployment partnerships for Indian-origin autonomous warfare systems across seven continents and 77 countries.



9. The Ayush Anudan Portal is mainly designed to:

आयुष अनुदान पोर्टल मुख्य रूप से निम्नलिखित के लिए डिज़ाइन किया गया है:

- Promote online AYUSH consultations
- Manage grant proposals under Central Sector Schemes
- Conduct digital health surveys
- Provide telemedicine services

Answer: B

Union Minister Shri Prataprao Jadhav Launches Ayush Anudan Portal under Ayush Grid Initiative

- Recently, the Union Minister of State (IC) for Ayush and Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare launched the Ayush Anudan Portal.
- It is **developed by the Ministry of Ayush under the Ayush Grid initiative**.
- It is a **digital platform** to streamline the submission, processing, and monitoring of funding proposals under Central Sector Schemes of the Ministry of Ayush i.e. **Ayurgyan, Ayurwashya, Conservation, Development and Sustainable Management of Medicinal Plants, International Co-operation and Promotion of Information, Education and Communication**.
- The **primary objective of this portal** is to ensure 100% transparency, efficiency, accountability and easy accessibility in the grant management process.
- The **portal can be accessed through the Ministry's My Ayush Integrated Services Portal (MAISP)**, which serves as the Ministry's single-window digital platform.



Features of the Portal

- It has a scheme-wise application management system, enabling proposals to be categorised, processed, and monitored **according to the specific requirements of different Central Sector Schemes of the Ministry**.
- It also incorporates a real-time application tracking mechanism, allowing applicants and officials to monitor proposal status at every stage of processing.
- It is **integrated with the NGO Darpan Portal**.

10. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 'Royal Order of the Polar Star, Degree Commander Grand Cross' conferred by Sweden was his _____ international honour.

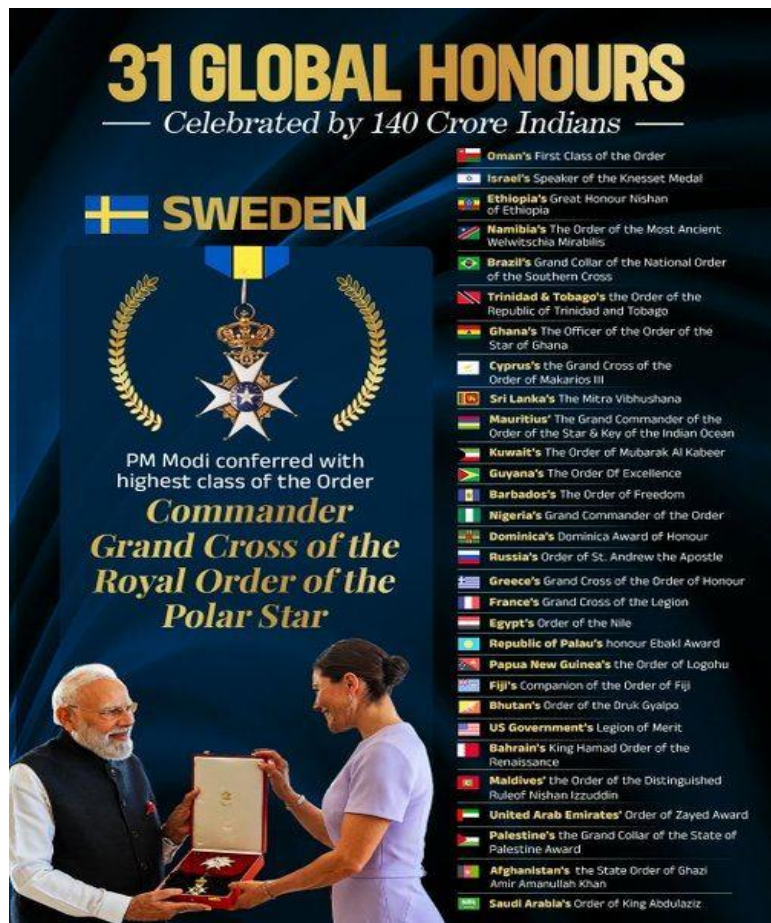
स्वीडन द्वारा प्रधानमंत्री नरेंद्र मोदी को प्रदान किया गया 'रॉयल ऑर्डर ऑफ द पोलर स्टार, डिग्री कमांडर ग्रेड क्रॉस' उनका _____ अंतरराष्ट्रीय सम्मान था।

A. 25th

B. 28th

C. 31st

Answer: C.



D. 35th



Sweden awards PM Modi Royal Order of the Polar Star

- The Prime Minister was conferred with Sweden's highest honor for a foreign head of government, the '**Royal Order of the Polar Star, Degree Commander Grand Cross**'.
- **This is Prime Minister Modi's 31st international honour.**
- The Royal Order of the Polar Star (Nordstjärneorden) is a prestigious Swedish order of chivalry.
- It is the **premier state distinction used by the Scandinavian nation to honor foreign heads of government, royalty, and individuals for outstanding public service**, breakthrough institutional achievements, and the successful execution of public duties that advance Swedish interests globally.
- **Institution:** The order was established on April 17, 1748, by King Fredrik I of Sweden.
- **The Enlightenment Focus:** It was historically dedicated to rewarding civic merit, science, literature, and institutional duty—symbolizing the Polar Star piercing through the darkness of ignorance.
- **Modern Reforms:** Following structural changes to Swedish orders in 1975, it became exclusively reserved for foreign citizens and stateless individuals who have rendered exceptional service to Sweden.
- Prime Minister Modi became the first Asian leader to receive the honor, highlighting India's rising global stature.

PM Modi receives Norway's highest civilian honour

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with Norway's highest civilian honour, the **Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit**, for his **contribution to advancing the India-Norway relationship and his leadership.**
- This is Prime Minister Modi's 32nd international honour.
- **King Harald V of Norway conferred** upon PM Modi the Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit.
- The Grand Cross is the highest grade of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit.
- It is awarded for exceptional service in advancing Norway's interests and international relations.



11. The crest design of the ship "Sanghmitra", recently launched at GRSE, Kolkata, depicts which constellation?

कोलकाता स्थित GRSE में हाल ही में लॉन्च किए गए जहाज़ "संघमित्रा" का क्रेस्ट डिज़ाइन किस तारामंडल को दर्शाता है?

- Orion
- Ursa Major
- Cassiopeia
- Pegasus

Answer: B



Launch of Sanghmitra, Yard 3039 (Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel) at M/S Grse, Kolkata

- Yard 3039 (Sanghmitra), **Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV)**, was launched at M/s GRSE, Kolkata
- **The construction of 11 NGOPVs is being undertaken concurrently at two shipyards (GSL, Goa and GRSE, Kolkata).**
- These indigenously designed and built ships will augment the existing OPVs/ NOPVs for **multi-domain operations, such as surveillance and defence in area of interest, search and rescue, protection of offshore assets, HADR, and anti-piracy missions.**
- **These ships derive their names from India's heritage, with this ship being named 'Sanghmitra', after the daughter of King Ashoka.**
- The crest design of the ship depicts the constellation of Ursa Major and a red and white coloured lighthouse.

12. The high-altitude Mahey Tokpo-Raldho irrigation canal was inaugurated in:

ऊँचाई पर स्थित माहे टोक्पो-राल्डो सिंचाई नहर का उद्घाटन किया गया था:

- (a) Himachal Pradesh
- (b) Uttarakhand
- (c) Ladakh
- (d) Sikkim

Answer: (c)

Mahey Tokpo-Raldho Canal Inaugurated in Ladakh's Changthang

- Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena **inaugurated the high-altitude irrigation canal in Changthang region**, constructed at an altitude of over 14,000 feet,
- The **Mahey irrigation canal**, along with the mass plantation drive, will immensely benefit the people of Changthang
- **The canal, draws water from Yaya Lake**

**13. Who has assumed charge as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)?**

भारतीय विशिष्ट पहचान प्राधिकरण (UIDAI) के मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी (CEO) का पदभार किसने ग्रहण किया है?

- A. Saurabh Garg
- B. Saurabh Vijay
- C. Amit Agrawal
- D. Rajesh Kumar

Answer: B.

Shri Saurabh Vijay assumes charge as Chief Executive Officer of Unique Identification Authority of India

- Shri Saurabh Vijay assumed charge as the Chief Executive Officer of Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI).
- He is an IAS officer of the 1998 batch of the Maharashtra cadre.
- He was Principal Secretary (Expenditure) in the Finance Department, Government of Maharashtra, prior to joining UIDAI.

About Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI):

- It is a **statutory authority** established under the provisions of the Aadhaar Act 2016 by the Govt. of India under the **Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology**.
- **Vision:** To empower residents of India with a unique identity and a digital platform to authenticate anytime, anywhere.
- It is **created to issue Unique Identification Numbers (UID)**, which is also known as 'Aadhaar number' to all the residents of India.
- Under the Aadhaar Act 2016, **UIDAI is responsible for Aadhaar enrolment and authentication**, including operation and management of all stages of the Aadhaar life cycle and the system for issuing Aadhaar numbers to individuals.
- **Composition:** UIDAI consists of a Chairperson, two part-time Members and the Chief Executive Officer (CEO), who is also the Member-Secretary of the Authority.

What is Aadhar?

- It is a **12-digit individual identification number issued by the UIDAI** to the residents of India after a certain verification process.
- To get an Aadhaar number, individuals have to provide minimal demographic and biometric information, which include name, date of birth or age, gender, address, mobile number, and e-mail ID (optional), fingerprints, iris scans, and a facial photo.
- It **serves as proof of identity and proof of address for residents of India**.
- The Aadhaar number is unique for each individual and will remain valid for a lifetime.
- It will help the residents to avail of various services provided by banking, mobile phone connections and other Govt and Non-Govt services in due course.

14. The Zwan-Wolf effect creates an area with:

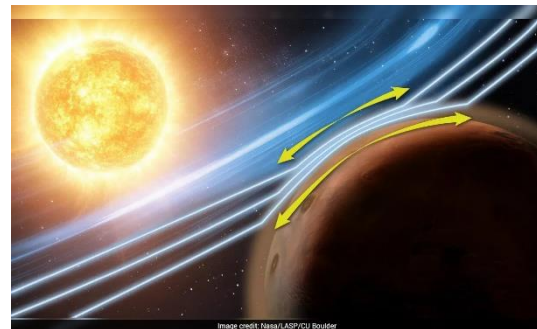
ज़्वान-वोल्फ़ प्रभाव एक ऐसा क्षेत्र निर्मित करता है जिसमें:

- A. Higher density of charged particles
- B. Increased oxygen levels
- C. High rainfall
- D. Lower density of charged particles

Answer: d

What is the Zwan-Wolf effect at Mars?

- In a new study published in *Nature Communications*, researchers from France, the U.K., and the U.S. **used the NASA MAVEN spacecraft to find evidence of the Zwan-Wolf effect at Mars**
- The solar wind is a stream of charged particles flowing outwards from the sun.
- As the solar wind nears the magnetic field of a planet, it becomes compressed near the magnetic boundaries.
- This creates a difference in pressure, or pressure gradient, that squeezes the charged particles along the magnetic field, away from the stream.
- As a result, **closer to the stream is an area with a lower density of charged particles. This is called the Zwan-Wolf effect.**
- **MAVEN had recorded the data containing the effect in December 2023, when a powerful solar storm called a coronal mass ejection struck Mars.**
- The event created intense magnetic structures in Mars's magnetic field that moved downwards into the planet's ionosphere.
- **These structures squeezed the charged particles in the ionosphere towards the planet's unlit side, reducing the local density of the particles by around 50%.**
- According to the researchers, the findings indicate that even "unmagnetised" planets like Mars can experience complex magnetic phenomena like the Zwan-Wolf effect.



15. The Mougari Mela generally falls during:

मौनगारी मेला आमतौर पर इस दौरान पड़ता है:

- (a) January–February
- (b) March–April
- (c) May–June
- (d) September–October

Answer: (c)

J&K: Mougari Mela also known as Shiv-Parvati Mela in Udhampur to commence

- Mougari Mela is **one of the famous Melas of Udhampur District which is organised with great religious fervour and gaiety every year on the eve of first Jyeshth** and lasts till the 3rd Jyeshth, which generally falls in May-June,
- At Sar Dabbar at a distance of 51 Kilometers from Udhampur which attracts thousands of visitors from within and outside the UT.
- The **historic 3-day annual Mougari Mela also known as Shiv-Parvati Mela**



16. Parliamentary privileges of Members of Parliament are primarily provided under:

संसद सदस्यों के संसदीय विशेषाधिकार मुख्य रूप से किसके अंतर्गत प्रदान किए जाते हैं?

- A. Article 32
- B. Article 105
- C. Article 123
- D. Article 368

Answer: B

The Privilege Notice

- Congress Chief Whip in the Rajya Sabha moved a formal privilege notice against Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.
- **A Privilege Notice is a specific institutional mechanism available to Members of Parliament (MPs) to raise a question of privilege when they believe an individual, minister, or organization has breached the defined rights, immunities, and privileges of the House, its committees, or its members.**
- If an individual disregards or insults these core protections, it is treated as a Breach of Privilege or Contempt of the House.

Aim:

- The fundamental aim of a privilege notice is **to protect the freedom, authority, dignity, and autonomy of Parliament** from external interference, misrepresentation, or derogatory attacks.
- It acts as a shield to ensure that parliamentarians can execute their legislative duties—and that parliamentary committees can function as mini-Parliaments—without fear, favor, or institutional denigration.

Key Features:

- **Grounded firmly in Article 105** (for Parliament and its members) and **Article 194** (for State Legislatures) of the Constitution of India.

Dual Nature: Privileges are split into two groups:

- **Individual Privileges:** Such as freedom of speech in Parliament and immunity from civil arrest 40 days before and after a legislative session.
- **Collective Privileges:** Such as the right of the House to publish its own records, exclude strangers, regulate its internal code, and punish both members and outsiders for contempt.
- **Committee Structure:** The Rajya Sabha Privileges Committee consists of 10 members, while the Lok Sabha panel comprises 15 members, both nominated proportionally to represent cross-party bench strengths.
- **Statutory Codification Gap:** Interestingly, India has never codified its parliamentary privileges into a single statutory law.



17. The unique Sarpabandha inscriptions are preserved at which historical site?

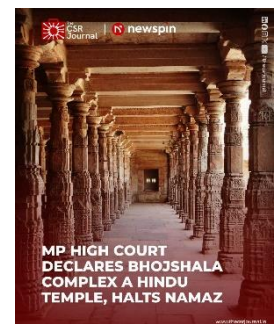
अद्वितीय 'सर्पबंध' अभिलेख किस ऐतिहासिक स्थल पर संरक्षित हैं?

- (a) Konark Sun Temple
(b) Bhojshala complex
(c) Khajuraho Temples
(d) Nalanda Mahavihara

Answer: (b)

Madhya Pradesh High Court Declares Bhojshala Complex a Temple

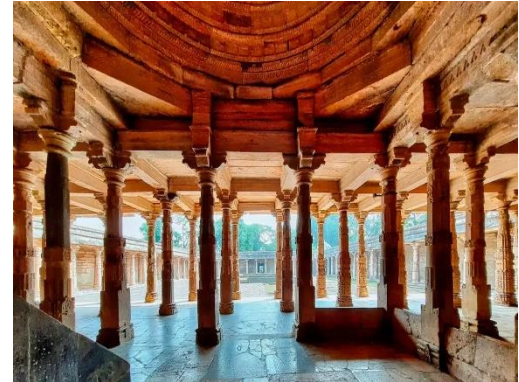
- The Indore Bench of the Madhya Pradesh High Court delivered a historic 242-page verdict declaring the **disputed Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Mosque complex in Dhar district a Hindu temple dedicated to Goddess Vagdevi (Saraswati).**
- The Bhojshala complex is an **11th-century protected historical monument that originally served as a premier center for Sanskrit learning** and a temple dedicated to Goddess Vagdevi (Saraswati).
- **Over centuries of regional shifts**, parts of the temple structure were utilized to construct the **Kamal Maula Mosque**, making it a **deeply contested religious site.**
- **Location:** Dhar (historically known as Dhara), Malwa region, Madhya Pradesh, India.
- **The city of Dhar, which served as the capital of the famous Paramara dynasty.**



- **The Foundation (1000–1055 A.D.):** Founded by Raja Bhoja, the most celebrated monarch of the Paramara dynasty.
- The center was expanded and maintained by immediate successors like Udayaditya and Naravarman, and later patronized by King Arjunavarma Deva (early 13th century).
- In the 14th century, during the rule of the Malwa Sultanate, **the site was converted into a mosque. It became associated with the tomb of the Sufi saint Shaikh Kamal Maula, giving rise to its dual identity.**
- It was **designated a protected monument under the Ancient Monuments Preservation Act in March 1904.**

Architectural Features:

- The monument features a large open courtyard surrounded by side colonnades and a prayer hall.
- The delicately carved pillars and decorated ceilings used throughout the mosque display definitive Hindu temple motifs and structures.
- **Sarpabandha Inscriptions:** The site uniquely preserves two Sarpabandha (serpentine chart) pillar inscriptions.
- **Stone slabs engraved with two distinct odes to the Kurma-Avatara** (the crocodile/tortoise incarnation of Lord Vishnu) written in Prakrit are fixed to the walls.
- **Classical Sanskrit Drama:** Slabs lining the mihrab contain a theatrical composition written by Royal Tutor Madana (disciple of Jain scholar Ashadhara) during King Arjunavarma's reign.
- The latest ASI survey recovered 94 sculptures (including images of Ganesha, Vishnu, and Narasimha) and documented chopped-off structural images along the pilasters.



18. The SMILE mission is a joint mission between:

SMILE मिशन एक संयुक्त मिशन है:

- National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) and Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- European Space Agency (ESA) and Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS)
- Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA) and Roscosmos State Corporation for Space Activities
- China National Space Administration (CNSA) and SpaceX

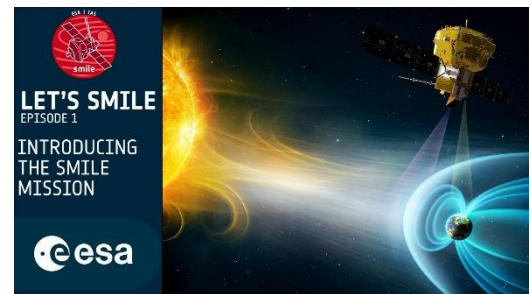
Answer: B.

The SMILE Mission

- **The European Space Agency (ESA) and the Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS) successfully launched their first-ever fully joint space mission, the Solar wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere Link Explorer (SMILE).**
- SMILE is a pioneering, multi-wavelength space exploration mission designed to observe **the global interaction between Earth's protective magnetic shield (the magnetosphere) and the highly charged plasma streamed by the Sun (the solar wind).**
- It marks a unique scientific bridge, merging European rocket tech and imaging sensors with Chinese engineering.

Aim:

- The fundamental objective of **SMILE is to capture the first-ever global X-ray and ultraviolet images of Earth's magnetic shield in active battle against solar winds.**
- It looks to map how our magnetosphere instinctively deforms, reacts, and self-corrects against severe solar flares and Coronal Mass Ejections (CMEs), unlocking the mysteries of the solar-terrestrial physics that make life on Earth possible.
- **Mission Life:** SMILE weighs about 2,600 kg and has a mission life of about three years.
- ESA has developed the Soft X-ray Imager (SXI), whereas the Chinese team has developed the other three payloads — Magnetometer, Light Ion Analyser (LIA) and Ultraviolet aurora Imager (UVI).



19. Who became the first woman officer in the Indian armed forces to earn the Cat-A Qualified Flying Instructor (QFI) qualification?

भारतीय सशस्त्र बलों में 'कैट-ए क्वालिफाइड फ्लाईंग इंस्ट्रक्टर' (QFI) योग्यता हासिल करने वाली पहली महिला अधिकारी कौन बनीं?

- A. Squadron Leader Saanya
- B. Wing Commander Anjali Singh
- C. Group Captain Shaliza Dhami
- D. Flight Lieutenant Avani Chaturvedi

Answer: A

Squadron Leader Saanya Becomes IAF's First Woman Cat-A Instructor

- Squadron Leader Saanya has achieved a historic milestone after becoming the first woman officer in the Indian armed forces to **earn the coveted Cat-A Qualified Flying Instructor (QFI) qualification**.
- Squadron Leader Saanya is an officer in the Flying branch who was commissioned on June 20, 2015, as part of the 42 SSC (W) FP Course. **She was elevated to the rank of Flight Lieutenant in 2017 and promoted to Squadron Leader in 2021.**

What is the Cat-A Qualified Flying Instructor (QFI) qualification?

- The IAF follows a **structured grading system** to assess the instructional proficiency of its pilots.
- Cat-C is assigned to trainee or probationary instructors, **Cat-B is meant for those qualified to provide standard flying instruction, while Cat-A represents the highest level, authorising pilots to train other instructors and evaluate advanced flying capabilities.**
- Cat-A Qualified Flying Instructors (QFIs) play a vital role in preparing the next generation of fighter pilots.



20. The conservation status of the Ganges soft-shell turtle under the IUCN Red List is:

IUCN रेड लिस्ट के अंतर्गत गंगा सॉफ्ट-शेल कछुए की संरक्षण स्थिति है:

- (a) Vulnerable
- (b) Near Threatened
- (c) Endangered
- (d) Critically Endangered

Answer: (c)

India Releases First Satellite-Tagged Ganges Soft-Shell Turtle

- India's first satellite-tagged Ganges soft-shell turtle was released **into its natural habitat along the northern bank of the Brahmaputra River inside Assam's Kaziranga National Park and Tiger Reserve.**
- The **Ganges soft-shell turtle (Nilssonina gangetica)**, also known as the **Indian softshell turtle**, is a large, highly aquatic freshwater reptile belonging to the family Trionychidae.
- It serves as an essential river apex predator and scavenger, playing a vital role in cleaning the riverine ecosystem by feeding on dead organic and animal matter.
- **It primarily inhabits deep, turbid rivers, large streams, canals, lakes, and reservoirs, showing a strong preference for wetlands with muddy or sandy bottoms where it can bury itself.**
- Widely distributed across South Asia, specifically in India, Bangladesh, Pakistan, and Afghanistan.
- In India, it is **densely found across major riverine ecosystems**, including the Indus, Ganges/Yamuna, Mahanadi, Narmada, and Brahmaputra basins.
- **IUCN Red List:** Endangered.
- **Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972:** Schedule I (Part II)



21. Which dance form is associated with the Etor Gidi festival?

एतोर गिडी उत्सव से कौन-सा नृत्य रूप जुड़ा है?

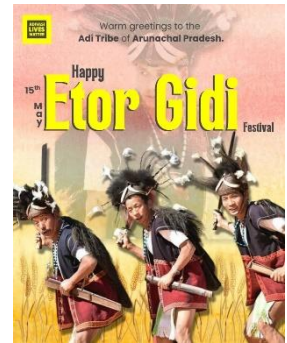
- (a) Bihu dance
- (b) Cheraw dance

- (c) Delong dance
(d) Wangala dance

Answer: (c)

Etor Gidi Festival Celebrated by Adi Community

- Etor Gidi is an agro-based traditional festival of the Adi community in Arunachal Pradesh.
- It is celebrated at the beginning of the farming season (generally falls in Mid May) and is associated with agricultural rituals, communal participation, and village-level customs.
- **Delong dance** is associated with the cultural observance of Etor Gidi.



22. The Urtan and Dhirauli coal mines are located in:

उर्टन और धिरोली कोयला खदानें स्थित हैं:

- A. Jharkhand
B. Odisha
C. Madhya Pradesh
D. Chhattisgarh

Answer: C

Urtan and Dhirauli Mines

- The Ministry of Coal announced the commencement of coal production from the Urtan and Dhirauli coal mines in Madhya Pradesh.
- The Urtan and Dhirauli mines are freshly operationalized, high-capacity coal blocks allocated to private players under the government's liberalized commercial coal mining framework.

Locations and Corporate Allocations:

Urtan Coal Mine:

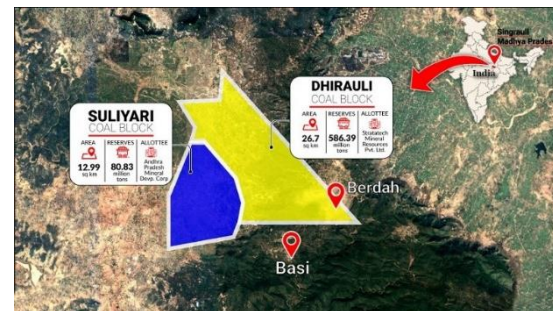
- Situated in the Anuppur district of Madhya Pradesh, this specialized underground asset has been allocated to M/s JMS Mining Private Limited.

Dhirauli Coal Mine:

- Located in the heavily industrialized Singrauli district of Madhya Pradesh, this large-scale block has been allocated to M/s Mahan Energen Limited (a subsidiary of Adani Power).

Key Features:

- Both blocks are structurally embedded within the resource-rich Gondwana rock system of central India, which archives over 98% of the country's total black coal deposits.
- The **Dhirauli mine forms a critical part of the continuous Soagpur-Singrauli coal basin. This region is geologically famous for hosting some of the thickest coal seams in the world**, blanketed underneath layers of structural sandstone and carbonaceous shales.
- The Urtan block is situated near the drainage basin of the Son and Narmada rivers.



23. Which of the following statements regarding the Anaimangalam Plates is/are correct?

1. They contain inscriptions in Sanskrit and Tamil.
2. The inscriptions deal with the genealogy of the Chola dynasty.
3. They were currently in the possession of Leiden University in Germany.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

India gets back Chola-era copper plates from Netherlands

- Chola-era plates, currently in the possession of Leiden University in the Netherlands, has been returned to India.
- The plates were presented during a formal ceremony in the presence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Dutch Prime Minister Rob Jetten in The Hague.
- The plates, also known as the Anaimangalam Plates, were lost around 300 years ago and have reportedly been in the possession of the university since 1862.**
- They are considered important sources of royal charters in south India and provide valuable historical information about the relationship between the Chola and Srivijaya Empires.**
- The inscriptions deal with the genealogy of the Chola dynasty and the reign of King Rajaraja I (985–1014 CE), the father of Rajendra Chola I (1012–1044 CE).
- Bilingual Composition:** The charters typically open with an elaborate genealogy of the Chola kings written in Sanskrit (using the Grantha script), followed by the minute operational details of the land grant written in Tamil.
- The charter records that 26 villages surrounding Anaimangalam were donated for a Buddhist shrine (vihara), known as Chulamanivarmavihara, built by the Malay king of Srivijaya in Nagapattinam, a port town on the Coromandel Coast.**
- An investigation found that the plates were likely excavated by the Dutch East India Company (VOC) in Nagapattinam between 1687 and 1700 and removed from India without the consent of the rightful owners.
- The Royal Seal (Insignia):** The plates are bound by a heavy bronze ring secured with an intricate royal seal. The seal depicts:
 - The **Tiger** (the dynastic emblem of the Cholas) sitting upright.
 - Twin Fish** (the emblem of the Pandyas) and a **Bow** (the emblem of the Cheras), positioned alongside the tiger to symbolize Chola suzerainty and military victories over their rivals.
 - Sacred and royal motifs including the **Parasol (white umbrella)**, two chamaras (fly-whisks), ceremonial lamps, a swastika, and the name of the issuing king or village.



Structural Setup: The Leiden collection is split into two distinct parts:

- The Larger Plates: A massive set of 21 large plates containing 5 Sanskrit and 16 Tamil inscriptions issued under Rajendra Chola I.
- The Smaller Plates: A supplementary set of 3 small Tamil plates issued under Kulottunga Chola I, detailing an additional grant of 4,500 kalam of paddy to the Buddhist sangha.

24. India's medal tally at the Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026 included:

एशियाई भारोत्तोलन चैंपियनशिप 2026 में भारत की पदक तालिका में शामिल थे:

- A. 2 gold, 3 silver and 5 bronze
- B. 1 silver and 9 bronze
- C. 4 silver and 6 bronze
- D. 10 bronze medals only

Answer: B

India bag 10 medals in Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026 in Gandhinagar

- India finished the Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026 in Gandhinagar with 10 medals, including one silver and nine bronze.**
- This was only the second time India hosted the Asian Weightlifting Championships after New Delhi hosted it in 1982.
- At the Asian Weightlifting Championships, **separate medals were awarded for the snatch and clean and jerk disciplines in addition to the medals for the overall total.**
- At the Asian Weightlifting Championships 2025 held in Jiangshan, India's two-member contingent of Dilbag Singh and Seram Nirupama Devi failed to win a medal.



Asian Weightlifting Championships 2026: Indian medal winners

- Silver:** Gyaneshwari Yadav (snatch women's 53kg)
- Bronze:** Komal Kohar (women's 48kg)

- Bronze: Komal Kohar (clean and jerk women's 48kg)
- Bronze: Gyaneshwari Yadav (women's 53kg)
- Bronze: Ajith Narayana (men's 71kg)
- Bronze: Ajith Narayana (clean and jerk men's 71kg)
- Bronze: Harjinder Kaur (women's 69kg)
- Bronze: Sanjana (women's 77kg)
- Bronze: Sanjana (women's clean and jerk 77kg)
- Bronze: Sanjana (women's snatch 77kg)

25. Which one of the following drugs is internationally referred to as the "Jihadi Drug"?

निम्नलिखित में से किस दवा को अंतरराष्ट्रीय स्तर पर "जिहादी दवा" के नाम से जाना जाता है?

- (a) Heroin
- (b) Cocaine
- (c) Captagon
- (d) LSD

Answer: (c)

Captagon Seized in India Under Operation Ragepill

- Union Home Minister Amit Shah announced **India's first-ever seizure of Captagon, a banned synthetic stimulant often referred to internationally as the "Jihadi Drug", in an operation valued at ₹182 crore.**
- The seizure was made under "**Operation Ragepill**"
- Captagon is a banned synthetic stimulant that has been linked internationally to organised crime networks and conflict zones in parts of West Asia.

Captagon

- It is a synthetic drug which was originally manufactured in Germany in the 1960s and 1970s where it was intended to treat attention deficit disorders.
- It was commercially sold in several countries until the 1980s and **was banned due to fears of its highly addictive nature.**
- It is **commonly known as "poor man's cocaine," has emerged as the drug of choice among young adults throughout the Middle East and North Africa.**
- It contains fenethylamine, a synthetic amphetamine, caffeine, and other stimulants.

26. Consider the following statements regarding Ebola:

1. Ebola spreads through direct contact with bodily fluids of infected persons.
2. There is no universally known cure for Ebola.

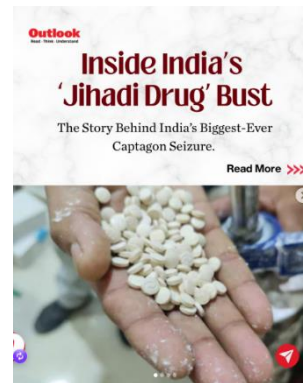
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

Confirmed Ebola Outbreak Reported in Congo

- Africa's top health agency has declared an Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo's eastern Ituri province.
- **It is a severe and often deadly disease caused by a group of viruses known as orthoebolaviruses (formally ebolavirus).**
- Orthoebolaviruses were discovered in 1976 in the Democratic Republic of the Congo and are found primarily in sub-Saharan Africa.
- It is **known as a hemorrhagic fever virus because it can cause problems with the clotting system of the body and lead to internal bleeding as blood leaks from small blood vessels.**
- Six different species of the virus have been found, but only four are known to cause disease in humans.



- It gets its name from the **Ebola River**, which is near one of the villages in the Democratic Republic of Congo where the disease first appeared.
- **Ebola can occur in humans and other primates (gorillas, monkeys, and chimpanzees).**

Transmission:

- The virus is transmitted to people from wild animals (such as fruit bats, porcupines, and non-human primates) and then spreads in the human population through direct contact with the blood, secretions, organs, or other bodily fluids of infected people and with surfaces and materials (e.g., bedding, clothing) contaminated with these fluids.
- **Ebola cannot be transmitted by air.**

Symptoms:

- It includes fever, diarrhea, vomiting, bleeding, and often, death.
- The average Ebola disease case fatality rate is around 50%. Case fatality rates have varied from 25–90% in past outbreaks.

Treatment:

- There is no known cure for Ebola.
- There are two FDA-approved monoclonal antibody treatments for the Ebola Zaire strain (Inmazeb and Ebanga).

27. Consider the following statements regarding Kumbhalgarh Fort:

1. It was built by Maharana Pratap in the 16th century.
2. It has been recognised as a UNESCO World Heritage Site under the Hill Forts of Rajasthan.
3. It is popularly known as the “Great Wall of India.”

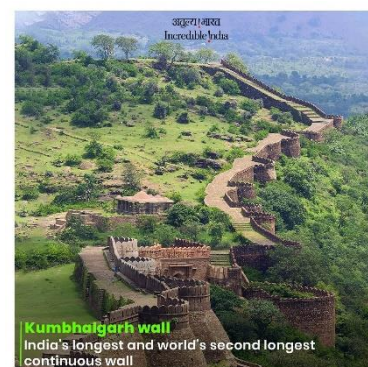
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
 B. 1 and 2 only
 C. 1 and 3 only
 D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Kumbhalgarh Fort

- **Kumbhalgarh Fort Wall in Rajasthan, often called the Great Wall of India, has been named the second-longest surviving wall in the world by a UNESCO survey.**
- It is located in the Rajsamand district of Rajasthan.
- It is strategically located in the **western Aravalli hills.**
- Considered to be the second most significant citadel in the **Mewar region after Chittorgarh**, this majestic fort was constructed in the 15th century AD by Rana Kumbha, **the ruler of the Kingdom of Mewar.**
- The massive fort is 3,600 feet tall.
- **Spanning over 36 kilometers**, its walls are second only to the Great Wall of China, earning it the moniker “the Great Wall of India.”
- The **fort has also been designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site** as part of the group of Hill Forts of Rajasthan.
- **The fort contains seven fortified gateways and over 360 ancient temples**—both Hindu and Jain, as well as the Lakhola Tank, the most famous tank within the fort, which was built by Rana Lakha.
- **For centuries, Kumbhalgarh Fort served as a refuge for Mewar rulers during times of war.**
- It is the birthplace of Mewar’s legendary king, Maharana Pratap. Maharana Pratap led numerous battles against the Mughal Empire, with Kumbhalgarh serving as his sanctuary.
- Its **defences could be breached only once by the combined armies of the Mughal and of Amber, primarily for scarcity of drinking water.**
- The fort is surrounded by the Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary.



28. Which shipyard built the vessels Dunagiri, Agray and Sanshodhak for the Indian Navy?

भारतीय नौसेना के लिए 'दुनागिरी', 'अग्रय' और 'संशोधक' जहाज़ किस शिपयार्ड ने बनाए थे?

- A. Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- B. Cochin Shipyard Limited
- C. Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)
- D. Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: C.

Dunagiri, Agray and Sanshodhak: Indian Navy to induct three indigenous vessels to boost maritime edge



- The Indian Navy is set to commission **three indigenous vessels** — a stealth frigate, an anti-submarine warfare craft and a survey ship — in a fresh push to strengthen its operational edge in the Indian Ocean Region,
- **The vessels — Dunagiri, Agray and Sanshodhak — were built by Kolkata-based Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE) and were recently delivered to the navy.**
- The three vessels, delivered recently by GRSE, represent different mission profiles: a **stealth frigate for multirole combat, an anti-submarine warfare shallow water craft for coastal defence, and a survey ship for hydrographic operations.**
- **INS Dunagiri** is the fifth stealth frigate under the ₹45,000-crore Project 17A program, which is delivering seven Nilgiri-class warships as successors to the Shivalik-class.
 - With around 75% indigenous content, these frigates are equipped with BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles, Barak-8 surface-to-air missiles, MF-STAR radar, and advanced anti-submarine warfare systems.
- **INS Agray** is the fourth of eight anti-submarine warfare shallow water craft (ASW-SWC) being built by GRSE.
 - Designed for operations in coastal waters and littoral zones, the 77-metre vessel is capable of sub-surface surveillance, search and attack missions, and can coordinate with aircraft for extended reach.
- **INS Sanshodhak** is a large survey vessel designed to conduct hydrographic surveys, chart coastal and deep-sea waters, and support navigation safety.

29. The Prime Minister was recently conferred with the prestigious Agricola Medal by which organization?

हाल ही में प्रधानमंत्री को किस संगठन द्वारा प्रतिष्ठित 'एग्रीकोला पदक' से सम्मानित किया गया?

- A. UNESCO – United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
- B. FAO – Food and Agriculture Organization
- C. WHO – World Health Organization
- D. IFAD – International Fund for Agricultural Development

Answer: B

PM Modi Receives FAO Agricola Medal



- The Prime Minister was recently conferred with the prestigious FAO Agricola Medal by the Food and Agriculture Organisation of the United Nations.
- **It is the highest honour conferred by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations.**
- It is awarded to **distinguished individuals who have played an exceptional role in advancing efforts toward global food security**, improved nutrition and agricultural development.
- It is considered one of the highest honours granted by the Organization in recognition of outstanding leadership and tangible contributions in these fields

Food and Agriculture Organization

- It is a specialized agency of the United Nations (UN) that leads international efforts to defeat hunger.
- **It is the oldest permanent specialized agency of the UN. FAO was founded on October 16, 1945**, when its constitution was signed in Canada's Quebec City by 34 countries.
- **Headquarters:** Rome, Italy.
- **Mandate:** To improve nutrition, increase agricultural productivity, raise the standard of living in rural populations, and contribute to global economic growth.

- The FAO also collaborated with the United Nations to establish the World Food Programme (WFP) to distribute surplus food to those in need.
- **Members:** It currently has 195 members – 194 countries and the European Union. (India is a founding member of FAO).
- **It is governed by the biennial FAO conference, in which each member country, as well as the EU, is represented.**
- **Funding:** FAO receives its funding from its member countries.
- **Reports published by the FAO:** The State of the World's Forests (SOFO), The State of World Fisheries and Aquaculture (SOFIA), The State of Agricultural Commodity Markets (SOCO), The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI).

30. Who won the women's singles title at the Italian Open 2026?

इटैलियन ओपन 2026 में महिला एकल का खिताब किसने जीता?

- A. Aryna Sabalenka
- B. Coco Gauff
- C. Iga Swiatek
- D. Elina Svitolina

Answer: D

Italian Open 2026 results

- The Italian Open 2026, also known as the Internazionali D'Italia.
- **Tennis world No. 1 Jannik Sinner defeated Norway's Casper Ruud in the Italian Open men's title final.**
- Sinner became the first Italian to win the men's singles title in Rome since Adriano Panatta in 1976,
- **Since becoming Italy's first men's world No. 1 in June 2024, Sinner has captured four major titles**, the Australian Open and US Open in 2024, followed by a second Australian Open crown and the Wimbledon title in 2025.
- **Elina Svitolina claimed a third Italian Open women's title by beating Coco Gauff.**
- Mirra Andreeva and Diana Shnaider won the 2026 Italian Open women's doubles title
- Simone Bolelli and Andrea Vavassori won the 2026 Italian Open men's doubles title
 - **Simone Bolelli and Andrea Vavassori beat Marcel Granollers and Horacio Zeballos 7-6(8) 6-7(3) 10-3 to become the first Italian pair to win the men's doubles title in 66 years**



31. India's first SME-led Semiconductor ATMP/OSAT facility has been established by:

भारत की पहली SME-नेतृत्व वाली सेमीकंडक्टर ATMP/OSAT सुविधा किसके द्वारा स्थापित की गई है?

- (a) Tata Electronics
- (b) Sahasra Semiconductors Pvt. Ltd.
- (c) Vedanta Semiconductors
- (d) Bharat Electronics Limited

Answer: (b)

Rajasthan Inaugurates First Semiconductor Cluster in Bhiwadi

- Rajasthan entered India's strategic semiconductor sector with the inauguration of its first Semiconductor ATMP/OSAT facility at Bhiwadi.
- **It is India's first SME-led Semiconductor ATMP/OSAT (Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging / Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test) facility established by Sahasra Semiconductors Pvt. Ltd.**



- To strengthen India's domestic semiconductor manufacturing and packaging ecosystem while reducing dependence on imports for strategic electronic components.
- Equipped with Class 10K and 100K cleanrooms and developed with an investment exceeding ₹150 crore under the SPECS scheme.

32. The Bhimmandali Eco Heritage Site is located in which state?

भीममंडली इको हेरिटेज साइट किस राज्य में स्थित है?

- (a) Odisha
- (b) Chhattisgarh
- (c) Jharkhand
- (d) West Bengal

Answer: (a)

Bhimmandali Eco Heritage Site Inaugurated in Sambalpur, Odisha

- Union Minister Dharmendra Pradhan inaugurated the Bhimmandali Eco Heritage Site in Sambalpur district of Odisha to preserve the region's prehistoric heritage and promote eco-tourism.
- The Bhimmandali Eco Heritage Site is located in the **Naktideul Forest Range of Sambalpur district in Odisha.**
- The site **contains ancient rock paintings and stone inscriptions believed to be over 20,000 years old**, indicating evidence of early human habitation from the Old Stone Age to the Neolithic period.
- **Objective:** The project aims to conserve prehistoric archaeological remains while boosting eco-tourism and local economic opportunities in the region.
- **Mythological Significance:** Bhimmandali is associated with the Pandavas from the Mahabharata and is **believed to have been linked to Bhima, after whom the site is named.**
 - The caves are also known for the **worship of Lord Shiva** and Goddess Parvati in the form of Gupeswar inside the cave complex.
- **Tourism Development:** The government plans to develop the site as a major global heritage and tourism destination with improved infrastructure and visitor facilities.

33. Consider the following statements regarding the Matua community:

1. The Matua sect is monotheist in nature.
2. The Matua movement originated in southern India.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

In Bengal, Matuas Line Up in Millions for Citizenship Under CAA

Community leaders, BJP hold camps to help refugees missing from 2002 rolls apply under the Act; Applications may cross 1 crore

Jayatri Nag

Kolkata: At a time when the national opposition is protesting alleged "vote theft" and the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Bihar, millions of applications for Indian citizenship under the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019, are pouring in from the Matua community across West Bengal.

Umbrella organisations of Matuas — a socio-religious group of Hindus who migrated from Bangladesh due to religious persecution — along

with the state BJP leadership, are working overtime to ensure Matuas and other refugees not listed in the state's voter rolls post 2002 SIR apply for citizenship under the CAA with the required documents.

"CAA applications will cross one crore people from the Matua community as a large number of people don't have names in the 2002 voter list," All India Matua Mahasangha general secretary Mahitosh Baidya told ET.

The CAA allows migrants from Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Pakistan who are Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, Parsis or Christians to obtain Indian citizenship.



Special camps are being held across the state to create awareness and assist people with the application process, people aware of the

matter said.

Central minister Sukanta Majumdar has organised one such camp at his residence in Balurghat for CAA awareness. Several BJP MLAs and leaders are doing the same. Haringhata MLA Asim Sarkar is participating in the process in several camps.

"If someone does not have names in 2002 electoral rolls, they could be in trouble during the (upcoming) SIR. So, we are creating CAA awareness camps and guiding them about applications — how to fill up CAA forms and apply for citizenship," said Majumdar, the Balurghat MP.

The 2002 SIR put the total number of voters in West Bengal at 45.8 million, spread over 80,000 polling booths. Sources said that in the 2002 exercise, 2.8 million names had been deleted from the electoral rolls.

It is learnt that several camps have been organised in Barasat and Bongaon Lok Sabha constituencies and South 24 Parganas district to help the Matuas and other backward refugee communities apply under the CAA. Matua Mahasangha, Sanatan Samaj and several other organizations are assisting in this process.

Matua Community

- **Most of the Matuas, who migrated from neighbouring Bangladesh during different time-periods do not have sufficient documents to apply for citizenship under the CAA.**
- The Matua community, a marginalized Hindu sect with roots in the 19th century, holds a significant socio-religious presence in the Bengal region, particularly across Bangladesh and West Bengal.
- **Founded by Harichand Thakur in the 1860s**, the Matua movement arose as a response to the deep-seated caste discrimination present within Hindu society at the time.

Religious Beliefs:

- As followers of the Matua faith, the **community primarily belongs to the “Namashudra” caste**, traditionally regarded as a lower-caste group within Hinduism.
- The **Matua sect is monotheist**.
- It **does not follow Vedic rituals**, and singing hymns in praise of the deity is their way of prayer and meditation.
- The **Matua have no distinctions of caste, creed, or class. They believe that everyone is a child of God.**
- Shrishriharililamrta is a principal religious scripture of the Matua.
- Following the partition of Bengal in 1947, the Matua community experienced profound socio-political shifts.
- **Many Matua families migrated to India to escape religious and political persecution, although a large portion of the community remained in what later became Bangladesh.**
- Today, Matuas constitute the second largest SC population of West Bengal

34. Consider the following pairs:

Craft / Art Form	State
1. Rogan Painting	Gujarat
2. Madhubani Painting	Bihar
3. Kalamkari	Andhra Pradesh
4. Blue Pottery	Punjab

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- A. 1, 2 and 3 only
 B. 1 and 4 only
 C. 2 and 3 only
 D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A

From Muga silk to Himalayan orchid art, Modi's gifts carry India's cultural message to five nations

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi wrapped up his five-nation visit to the UAE, Netherlands, Sweden, Norway and Italy

Italy

- Not just a pack of India toffee, Melody, Prime Minister Narendra Modi also gifted - **A Muga Silk stole from Assam**, which is a fabric renowned for its natural golden sheen and durability with a **Shirui Lily-inspired silk stole** symbolising the cultural identity of Manipur's Tangkhul Naga community.
- The **Shirui Lily silk stole** draws its inspiration from the misty heights of Shirui Kashong Peak in Manipur, India.
- It is inspired **by the rare Shirui Lily, a delicate bell-shaped flower** with pale pinkish-white petals that blooms nowhere else in the world.
- For the Tangkhul Naga community of Manipur, the Shirui Lily symbolises purity, identity, and cultural pride.
- **Italian President Sergio Mattarella received a marble inlay work box made in Agra.**
- The Marble Inlay Box is a refined example of India's handcrafted artistry, closely associated with the master craftsmen of Agra.



Muga Silk Stole. (Source: Express Photo)



Shirui Lily silk stole. (Source: Express Photo)

- **Created using the intricate art of Pacchikari, or Pietra Dura**, this decorative tradition is believed to have originated in Florence, Italy, before flourishing in India
- Crafted from polished white marble, the box is adorned with delicate inlay work using semi-precious stones such as lapis lazuli, turquoise, malachite, coral, and mother-of-pearl.
- Inside the box are treasured musical compilations by two of the greatest icons of Indian classical music: **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi and M.S. Subbulakshmi**.
- Pandit Bhimsen Joshi, the legendary Hindustani vocalist and Bharat Ratna awardee, was renowned for his powerful and deeply emotive performances.
- M.S. Subbulakshmi, the iconic Carnatic vocalist and the first musician to receive the Bharat Ratna.



Netherlands

- The Dutch king was gifted **Blue pottery from Jaipur**, Rajasthan, is a renowned, GI-tagged art.
- It is crafted from a unique mixture of quartz powder, powdered glass and Fuller's earth, which gives it a striking, glass-like finish.
- **This non-clay composition requires specialised firing techniques to achieve its characteristic translucence and brilliant cobalt-blue hues**, typically adorned with intricate floral and bird motifs.
- While the Dutch Queen received **Meenakari and Kundan earrings** in orange and blue colours associated with the Dutch royal House of Orange-Nassau.
- These Meenakari and Kundan earrings **embody the finest traditions of Indian jewelry craftsmanship, originating from the royal ateliers of Rajasthan**.
- They unite two historic art forms: Meenakari, the delicate enameling of vibrant colours onto metal, and Kundan, the setting of uncut gemstones in refined gold foil.
- Dutch Prime Minister Rob Jetten's was presented with a **Madhubani painting**.
- This **painting is a GI-tagged folk art tradition from the Mithila region of India and Nepal**, renowned for its intricate geometric patterns and vibrant colours.
- Traditionally practiced by women, it has long been used to mark festivals, weddings, and sacred rituals.
- Rooted in Indian mythology and folklore.

Norway

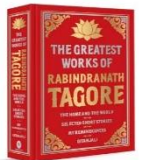
- Norway Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Støre **received pressed orchid artwork sourced from Sikkim**.
- These exquisite artworks celebrate the extraordinary biodiversity of the Eastern Himalayas.
- While King Harald V was gifted a silver filigree sailboat model from Odisha.
- This exquisite silver sailboat is a masterpiece of **Tarakasi, the ancient art of silver filigree from Cuttack, Odisha, often referred to as India's "Silver City"**.
- Queen Sonja of Norway received a **palm leaf Pattachitra**.
- This palm leaf is locally known as Tala Pattachitra, is one of Odisha's most ancient and intricate art forms.
- Unlike cloth-based paintings, this **tradition involves engraving detailed illustrations onto carefully treated palm leaves sourced from the Palmyra tree**.
- Crown Prince Haakon, Crown Prince of Norway was presented with a **Kalamkari artwork featuring Sun and Moon motifs** inspired by cosmic balance.



- Kalamkari is an ancient Indian art form known for its hand-painted or block-printed cotton textiles, created using natural dyes and intricate storytelling motifs.
- **Originating in Andhra Pradesh, it flourished in two distinct styles: Srikalahasti, defined by freehand drawing with a bamboo pen, and Machilipatnam, recognised for its hand-carved wooden block printing.**

Sweden

- Sweden's Prime Minister Ulf Kristersson was **gifted a Shantiniketan messenger bag, works of Rabindranath Tagore, Loktak Tea from Manipur and a Ladakh wool stole.**
- This handcrafted bag hails from Shantiniketan, the 'Abode of Peace,' a sanctuary where Gurudev Rabindranath Tagore envisioned a global meeting of minds.
- The traditions at Shantiniketan endures; the leather work is a Geographical Indication (GI) protected craft that provides a sustainable livelihood for hundreds of artisans in the Birbhum district, West Bengal



A selection of works by Rabindranath Tagore

- Rabindranath Tagore was one of the most influential literary and philosophical voices of the 20th century.
- In 1913, he became the first non-European to receive the Nobel Prize in Literature for Gitanjali.

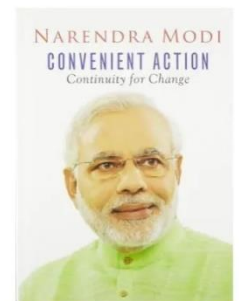
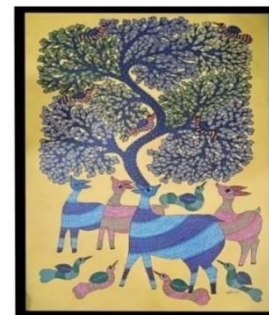
Loktak Tea

- Loktak Tea is an artisanal, small-batch tea from the lush hills surrounding Loktak Lake, the largest freshwater lake in Northeast India.



Ladakh Pure Wool Stole

- The Ladakh Pure Wool Stole, also known as the Pashmina shawl, is the soul of the Himalayas woven into fabric.
- Originating from the remote Changthang plateau at altitudes above 5,000 meters, **it is crafted from the delicate under-fleece of the Changthangi goat, naturally adapted to survive the region's extreme cold.**
- Victoria, Crown Princess of Sweden received a Gond painting alongside the **book Convenient Action: Continuity for Change.**
- This painting is a vibrant form of **tribal art practiced by the Gondi people**, one of the largest indigenous communities of Madhya Pradesh, India.



Convenient Action- Continuity for Change

- Convenient Action: Continuity for Change by Prime Minister of India is a collection of speeches, reflections, and policy perspectives that present the author's vision for governance, development, and national progress.
- The Prime Minister of Iceland is **Kristrún Mjöll Frostadóttir was presented with a replica of the ice axe used by Tenzing Norgay.**
- The Replica of the Ice Axe pays tribute to the legendary tool carried by Tenzing Norgay during the first successful ascent of Mount Everest in 1953 with Sir Edmund Hillary.
- Crafted in steel with a polished wooden shaft.



Denmark's Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen **received a Bidri silver work vase.**

- **The Bidri Silver Work Vase reflects the refined artistry of the Deccan, celebrated for its intricate silver inlay, elegant form, and meticulous craftsmanship., a tradition perfected over generations by artisans of Hyderabad and the Deccan plateau.**
- While Finland's Prime Minister **Petteri Orpo was gifted a Kamal Talai Pichwai painting rooted in Rajasthan's Nathdwara tradition.**
- The Kamal Talai Pichwai painting reflects the serene beauty and devotional artistry of the Nathdwara tradition of Rajasthan.



UAE

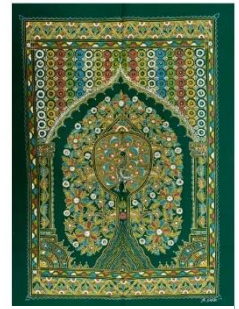
- UAE President Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan received a Rogan painting featuring the “Tree of Life” motif, along with GI-tagged Kesar mangoes and Meghalaya pineapples.

Rogan Painting with Tree of Life

- Rogan painting is a rare and exquisite textile art form from the Kutch region of Gujarat, celebrated for its intricate craftsmanship and vibrant aesthetic tradition.

Kesar Mangoes

- The Kesar Mango, a GI-tagged also called as Gujarat’s “Queen of Mangoes,” originated in Junagadh, Gujarat.
- Distinguished by its saffron-hued, fibreless pulp and intense aroma, it is celebrated through “Aamras” feasts that symbolise Gujarati hospitality and a prestigious heritage of tropical excellence.**

**Meghalaya Pineapple**

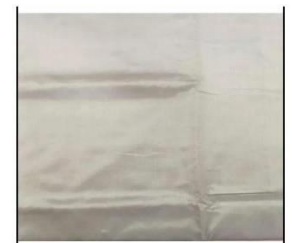
- These GI-tagged pineapples are celebrated as some of the finest in the world, thriving in the pristine, hilly terrains of Meghalaya, India, containing high levels of bromelain, an enzyme that aids digestion and reduces inflammation, as well as being rich in Vitamin C and antioxidants
- UAE Crown Prince received **Mithila Makhana**, also known as fox nut or lotus seeds, is a premium agricultural product from the **Mithila region of Bihar, recognised with a Geographical Indication (GI) tag for its unique origin and quality.**
- While the UAE Queen Mother Sheikha Fatima bint Mubarak Al Ketbi received a **Karimnagar filigree box**, Maheshwari silk fabric and Manipur’s famed Chak Hao black rice.

**Karimnagar Filigree box**

- This intricate silver chest from Karimnagar is a distinguished example of India’s celebrated nakkashi metalcraft tradition.

Maheshwari Silk fabric

- Maheshwari silk represents one of India’s most elegant handloom traditions, originating in the historic town of Maheshwar on the banks of the Narmada River in Madhya Pradesh.
- Celebrated for its refined blend of silk and cotton.
- The tradition is closely linked to the visionary ruler Queen Ahilyabai Holkar.**
- It is especially known for its reversible borders, or Bugdi,

**35. Which country is hosting the 68th Governing Body meeting of the Asian Productivity Organization (APO)?**

एशियाई उत्पादकता संगठन (APO) की 68वीं गवर्निंग बॉडी बैठक की मेज़बानी कौन सा देश कर रहा है?

- A. India
- B. Japan
- C. Singapore
- D. Thailand

Answer: a

India to Host 68th Session of Asian Productivity Organization Governing Body in New Delhi

- India is hosting the 68th Governing Body meeting of the Asian Productivity Organization in New Delhi**, Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal is scheduled to attend the inaugural session
- The **three-day meeting**, being held from May 20 to 22 at **Bharat Mandapam**, will see participation from more than 60 senior delegates representing 20 APO member economies,
- The **discussions are expected to focus on the APO Vision 2030 framework**, budget proposals for 2027–28 and reforms linked to the election process for the organisation’s secretary-general.



- **Observers from Kazakhstan, Uzbekistan and Bhutan, along with representatives of the Global Green Growth Institute, are also participating in the session**
- India currently chairs the APO Governing Body after Amardeep Singh Bhatia, Secretary in the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), assumed the role during last year's governing body meeting.
- **Established in 1961, the APO is an intergovernmental organisation comprising 21 member economies in the Asia-Pacific region and works on productivity enhancement through policy cooperation, technical support and knowledge-sharing initiatives.**

36. India's first SEBI-approved exchange-traded weather derivatives contract "RAINMUMBAI" was launched by:

भारत का पहला SEBI-अनुमोदित एक्सचेंज-ट्रेडेड मौसम डेरिवेटिव अनुबंध "RAINMUMBAI" किसके द्वारा लॉन्च किया गया था?

- A. NSE – National Stock Exchange
 B. BSE – Bombay Stock Exchange
 C. NCDEX – National Commodities and Derivatives Exchange
 D. MCX – Multi Commodity Exchange

Answer: C



NCDEX introduces RAINMUMBAI weather future contracts

- **The National Commodities and Derivatives Exchange (NCDEX) recently announced the launch of India's first SEBI-approved exchange-traded weather derivatives contract, named "RAINMUMBAI".**
- It is India's first exchange-traded weather derivatives contract.
- It was launched by the National Commodity and Derivatives Exchange (NCDEX).
- The instrument will be used to hedge losses from unpredictable weather and monsoon variability.
- **Unlike conventional insurance products, weather derivatives are settled directly against observed weather data rather than physical loss assessments,** enabling faster payouts and reducing operational complexity.
- These products are widely used globally by sectors such as agriculture, power, construction, logistics, tourism, and energy, where revenues can be heavily impacted by weather variability.
- **RAINMUMBAI, which has received approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), was developed in collaboration with the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay, based on rainfall data in Mumbai.**
- India Meteorological Department (IMD) surface rainfall and automatic weather stations (AWS) observations at Santacruz and Colaba will be the source of rainfall data.

What are Derivatives?

- Derivatives are financial contracts that derive value from an underlying asset.
- **Common underlying assets:** Stocks, bonds, commodities, currencies, interest rates, and market indexes.
- **Derivatives allow traders to bid on the direction of the underlying asset's price change without owning them.**
- They allow investors to speculate on price movements, hedge against risks, or enhance portfolio returns.

37. Which Indian grandmaster became the first Indian to qualify for the Esports World Cup (EWC) 2026 chess event?

कौन सा भारतीय ग्रैंडमास्टर Esports World Cup (EWC) 2026 के शतरंज इवेंट के लिए क्वालीफाई करने वाला पहला भारतीय बन गया है?

- A. R Praggnanandhaa
 B. D Gukesh
 C. Aravindh Chithambaram
 D. Vidit Gujrathi

Answer: C

Aravindh becomes 1st Indian chess player to qualify for Esports World Cup.

- Aravindh Chithambaram became the first Indian grandmaster to secure a spot in the **Esports World Cup (EWC) 2026** after he emerged victorious in the Road to EWC qualifier held at DreamHack Atlanta.



- \$15,000 (approximately Rs 14 lakh) in prize money
- **EWC 2026 chess main event, set to take place from August 11 to 15** with an overall prize pool of \$1.5 million (approx Rs 14 crore).

38. Which country will provide a payload for India's upcoming Venus Orbiter Mission, Shukrayaan-1?

भारत के आगामी शुक्र ऑर्बिटर मिशन, 'शुक्रयान-1' के लिए कौन-सा देश पेलोड उपलब्ध कराएगा?

- A. France
- B. Germany
- C. Sweden
- D. Japan

Answer: C

The Prime Minister reached Norway for the 3rd India-Nordic Summit 2026

- In the fourth leg of his visit, the Prime Minister reached Norway for the 3rd India-Nordic Summit and bilateral engagements.
- The **Nordic countries**, also known as the Nordic region, are a group of countries in northern Europe consisting of **Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, and Sweden**.
- The designation includes the Faroe Islands and Greenland, which are autonomous island regions of Denmark, and the Åland Islands, an autonomous island region of Finland.



- **Scandinavia** is typically defined more restrictively, however, and refers primarily to **Norway, Sweden, and Denmark**.
- **Sweden** is the **largest** and most populous of the Nordic countries. Iceland is the least populous.
- **Denmark** is the **smallest**.
- Denmark, Sweden, and Norway are constitutional monarchies and parliamentary democracies.
- Finland and Iceland are democratic republics.
- **Iceland's parliament, the Althing, is the oldest parliament in the world.**



3rd The India-Nordic Summit Outcomes

- Prime Minister of India co-chaired the 3rd India-Nordic Summit in Oslo, **Norway (host)**, alongside the heads of government from Denmark, Norway, Finland, Iceland, and Sweden.
- **The India-Nordic Summit is an elite plurilateral diplomatic platform that brings together India and the five Nordic nations (Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, and Sweden).**
- **Building upon previous iterations in Stockholm (2018) and Copenhagen (2022)**, this forum aligns India's massive market scale and human talent with the Nordic region's pioneering strengths in clean energy, maritime technologies, and deep-tech innovation.

Key Outcomes of the 2026 Summit:

- Formally elevated the plurilateral dynamic into a Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partnership.
- **Welcomed the operationalization of the India-EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA)**—anchoring a target of \$100 billion in investments and 1 million direct jobs in India—alongside progress on the India-EU FTA.
- **The five Nordic nations reiterated their formal support for India's permanent membership in a reformed UN Security Council (UNSC) and backed India's application to the Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG).**
- **Space and Deep-Tech Pacts:** Announced a new Framework Agreement between ISRO and the Norwegian Space Agency, as well as a confirmed Swedish payload for India's upcoming Venus Orbiter Mission (Shukrayaan 1).
- **Maritime & Blue Economy Mandates:** Initiated dedicated Maritime Security Dialogues with Norway and Denmark to counter Illicit Maritime Activities (IMA) under India's 'MAHASAGAR' vision and the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI).
- **Climate & Industrial Transition:** Expanded the LeadIT 2.0 (Leadership Group for Industry Transition) platform by formally welcoming Iceland as its newest Nordic member to help de-carbonize heavy industries.
- Confirmed that the upcoming 4th India-Nordic Summit **will be hosted by Finland.**

39. Suryastra, recently tested by Nibe Limited, is India's first indigenous:

निबे लिमिटेड द्वारा हाल ही में परीक्षण किया गया 'सूर्यास्त्र', भारत का पहला स्वदेशी है:

- A. Ballistic missile defence system
- B. Multi-calibre rocket launcher system
- C. Hypersonic cruise missile
- D. Anti-drone warfare platform

Answer: B

Suryastra Rocket System

- India recently achieved a major milestone in indigenous defence technology after **private defence firm Nibe Limited successfully tested the long-range Suryastra rocket system at Chandipur.**
- It is India's first indigenous **universal multi-calibre rocket launcher system.**
- It is developed by Pune-based NIBE Limited in collaboration with Israel's Elbit Systems.
- It is **designed to deliver precision strikes against enemy positions, command centres, radar installations and logistics hubs deep inside hostile territory**
- India recently achieved a major milestone in indigenous defence technology after **private defence firm Nibe Limited successfully tested the long-range Suryastra rocket system at Chandipur.**
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- It is **designed to deliver precision strikes against enemy positions, command centres, radar installations and logistics hubs deep inside hostile territory**
- It is an advanced **long-range rocket launcher system.**
- It is **mounted on a highly mobile 6×6 Tatra truck.**
- It is designed to engage multiple targets simultaneously at varying ranges.
- This includes **122 mm rockets** for closer engagements, **306 mm EXTRA missiles** capable of hitting targets at 150 kilometres, and **370 mm Predator Hawk missiles** that can reach up to 300 kilometres.
- The **system can also launch SkyStriker loitering munitions**—often referred to as suicide drones, capable of traveling up to 100 kilometres .
- **The system is based on Elbit Systems' PULS (Precise & Universal Launching System) launcher technology.**

**40. The newly built 'Million Minds Tech Park' and 'GREMI City Campus' inaugurated by Amit Shah are located in which state?**

अमित शाह द्वारा उद्घाटित नव-निर्मित 'मिलियन माइंड्स टेक पार्क' और 'GREMI सिटी कैम्पस' किस राज्य में स्थित हैं?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Gujarat

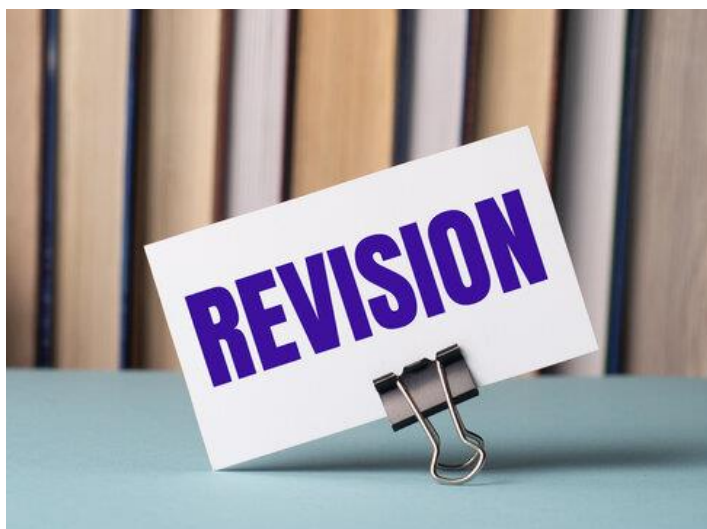
(c) Rajasthan

(d) Karnataka

Answer: (b)

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Shri Amit Shah inaugurates newly built 'Million Minds Tech Park' and 'GREMI City Campus'

- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation, Shri Amit Shah, **inaugurated the newly built 'Million Minds Tech Park' and 'GREMI City Campus' in Ahmedabad, Gujarat.**
- the 'Million Minds Tech Park', developed across 13.5 lakh square feet at a **cost of nearly Rs. 1,100 crore, will in its first phase provide a state-of-the-art work environment for 9,000 highly skilled professionals.**
- Ganesh Real Estate Management Institute (GREMI) Campus institute is an important initiative for the country as the real estate sector has rarely been approached in a comprehensive manner.



Important Headlines

- Indian author Ruskin Bond marked his 92nd birthday on 19 May 2026 by launching his newest anthology, All-Time Favourite Friendship Stories, in Dehradun.
- Ali Falih Kadhim al-Zaidi took charge as Iraq's Prime Minister
- The Haryana government has appointed senior IPS officer Sibash Kabiraj as the new Police Commissioner of Gurugram, replacing Vikram Kumar Arora.
- Tushar Kumar has made history by becoming the youngest Indian-origin mayor of the United Kingdom's Elstree & Borehamwood at just 23 years old.
- Professor Salim Abdool Karim and Professor Keertan Dheda, two Indian-origin public health scientists, received South Africa's highest civilian honour, the Order of Mapungubwe in Pretoria.
- Former Uttarakhand Chief Minister and senior BJP leader B C Khanduri passed away
- K. Balakrishnan, former owner and chief editor of Express, a former Thrissur-based Malayalam daily, passed away
- Indian-origin tech veteran "Soma" Somasegar, a former Microsoft executive and managing director at Madrona Venture Group, has died at the age of 59
- For Class 9 CBSE students, what is set to change immediately is that starting July 1, they will have to study three languages, with at least two of them being "native Indian languages".
- NIOS Launches Initiative to Reconnect Out-of-School Children with Education Under NEP 2020 Vision
- Shivraj Singh Chouhan is scheduled to attend the "Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G) Beneficiary Conference & Maha Awaas Abhiyan State-Level Award Distribution Ceremony" in May 2026 in Satara, Maharashtra.
- The Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD) convened a high-level national consultation in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, to finalize the operational guidelines for the newly launched SHE-MART initiative.

- The three-member Judges Inquiry Committee submitted its formal investigation report to Lok Sabha Speaker concerning misbehavior allegations against sitting judge Justice Yashwant Varma.
- The centuries-old community-led spring cleaning and fish-catching festival at Panzath Nag in Jammu and Kashmir's Anantnag district was recently observed with participation from thousands of villagers.
- India's flagship global textile event, Bharat Tex 2026 will be held in New Delhi from 14th to 17th July 2026.
- Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the 'Metro Monday' initiative, joining ministers and government officials in using public transport as part of a campaign focused on sustainable mobility and fuel conservation.
- Delhi Metro Rail Corporation has begun operating the first hydrogen-powered shuttle bus service in the Centra Vista area
- The National AI Doctors Mission (NAIDM) was launched at Health AI Con 2026 in New Delhi on 17 May 2026.
- The National Test House (NTH) of Northern Region in Ghaziabad, under the Department of Consumer Affairs, has established a state-of-the-art Shoe Testing Laboratory.
- The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet approved the formation of the Other Backward Classes (OBC) commission for the three-tier rural bodies.
- Rathindra Bose, Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MLA from the Cooch Behar Dakshin Assembly seat, was elected as the Speaker of West Bengal Legislative Assembly.
- The West Bengal Cabinet has given in-principle approval for the formation of the 7th Pay Commission for state government employees, staff of government boards and corporations, state-aided bodies, and educational institutions.
- West Bengal has raised the upper age limit for recruitment to state government jobs from 11 May 2026 through amendments to the West Bengal Services (Raising of Age-limit) Rules, 1981.
- Sikkim commemorates its statehood day annually on May 16 to acknowledge its integration with India and its emergence as the 22nd state in the country in 1975.
- The Union Minister for Development of North Eastern Region and Communications, Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, launched the Cluster-based Coffee Value Chain Development Mission for Nagaland.
- Three Thadou Tribe Church Leaders were shot dead and several others injured after unidentified armed men ambushed their vehicles in Manipur's Kangpokpi district recently.
- Recently, the Union Minister for Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER) launched the ₹189.79-crore Mizoram Ginger Mission.
- Tripura has created history by becoming the first State in India to complete all Priority Areas under Deregulation Phase-II of the national Compliance Reduction and Deregulation initiative led by the Cabinet Secretariat of the Government of India.
- Hon'ble Union Home and Cooperation Minister Shri Amit Shah inaugurated the state-of-the-art automated milk processing and packaging plant of Madhur Dairy Unit-2 at Dashela in Gandhinagar, Gujarat.
- NITI Aayog organized a two-day National Workshop on "Grassroots Innovation Pathways – From Local Resilience to National Advancements" on 19th – 20th May 2026 at Science City, Ahmedabad, Gujarat in collaboration with the Gujarat Council on Science and Technology (GUJCOST) and the National Innovation Foundation – India.
- The Maharashtra government has launched the 'Kasa Kay?' public awareness campaign under the 'Majhe Gaav, Arogya Sampanna Gaav' initiative to strengthen healthcare awareness in rural areas.
- The National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management (NCSCM) recently completed the documentation and ground-truthing of all but 11 of Maharashtra's 23,415 wetlands.
- A historic Pulicat Lake draws birders and photographers from across South India who visit the lake to see the graceful flamingo in still waters.
- Trachischium lalremsangai is a new worm-eating snake species described in the journal Herpetozoa on 19 May 2026.
- The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) released a landmark report titled Sand and Sustainability: An Essential Resource for Nature and Development.

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi called on Their Majesties Willem-Alexander and Máxima at Palace Huis ten Bosch in The Hague during his visit to the Netherlands.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited the iconic Afsluitdijk water management structure in the Netherlands along with Dutch Prime Minister Rob Jetten.
- Prime Minister of India made a landmark diplomatic stopover in Abu Dhabi, holding wide-ranging talks with UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan.
- PM Modi wore the traditional Bodo 'Aronai' scarf in The Hague, showcasing Assam's handloom heritage on a global platform.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his Norwegian counterpart Jonas Gahr Støre officially upgraded bilateral ties to a Green Strategic Partnership during a historic state visit to Oslo.
- India and Italy will work towards further developing the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) and announced that 2027 will be observed as the "Year of Culture and Tourism" between the two countries.
- Italian artist Giampaolo Tomassetti presented Prime Minister Narendra Modi with a painting on Varanasi during his visit to Italy
- Russian President Vladimir Putin will attend the BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12-13.
- The Euphrates, one of the oldest and most storied rivers in human history, is disappearing.
- Scientists working in Antarctica have identified the oldest directly dated ice and air sample on Earth from the Allan Hills region of East Antarctica.
- A 38-year-old man has died after a suspected shark attack near Rottnest Island recently, an Australian island in the Indian Ocean at western Australia.
- In Badminton, India's Shriyanshi Valishetty clinched the silver medal in women's singles at the Baoji China Masters in China in the summit clash of the Super 100 event at Baoji City Gymnasium.
- The world No. 1 set a new tennis record as he became the first man to win 32 consecutive singles matches at ATP Masters 1000 level, the tier below the Grand Slams.
- India's Siddhant Banthia and his Bulgarian partner Alexander Donski won the doubles title at Oeiras Open 4 2026, an ATP Challenger 100 tennis tournament, in Portugal,
- English golfer Aaron Rai won the PGA(Professional Golfers' Association) Championship 2026 at Aronimink Golf Club.
- VR46 Racing's Fabio Di Giannantonio claimed victory at the Catalan Grand Prix

QUESTION OF THE DAY

Consider the following statements regarding the Indus Waters Treaty (IWT):

1. Under the treaty, all waters of the Eastern Rivers were allocated to Pakistan.
2. Jhelum, Chenab and Indus are classified as Western Rivers.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2